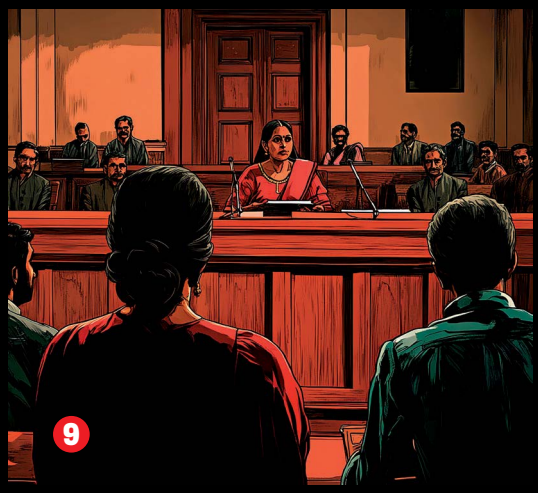


ESCALATION TO 'HIGHER AUTHORITIES'

A 'senior officer' takes over, explaining the gravity of the situation and sharing fake arrest warrants or notices from agencies like the CBI, ED, RBI or even the Supreme Court. The victims are instructed to isolate themselves and participate in a 'verification' process via Skype



PSYCHOLOGICAL MANIPULATION

During the video call, the victim witnesses staged 'live' wireless conversations and court proceedings. Under 'digital arrest', they are prohibited from contacting anyone. The scammers alternate between aggressive threats (bad cop) and compassionate reassurance (good cop) to build trust and extract information



EXTRACTING MONEY

Once trust is gained, the scammers propose a 'solution'—transferring money to 'government accounts' (mule accounts) until the victim's name is cleared. The frightened victims begin transferring money

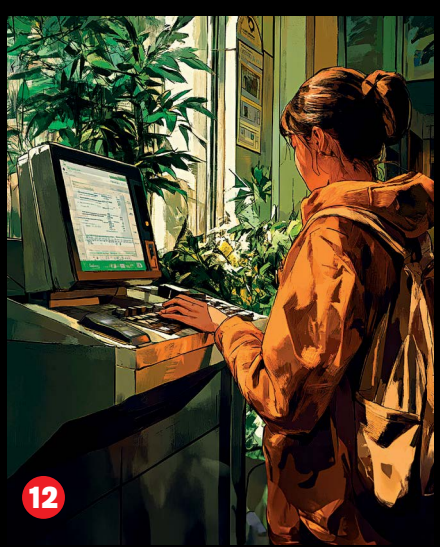


ESCALATING THREATS

If the victim appears vulnerable, scammers escalate their tactics, including blackmail with morphed images or threats against family members. The harassment persists until the victim exhausts their resources or seeks help from the police

THE MONEY TRAIL

Funds from one mule account are dispersed across multiple mule accounts before being funnelled even to Southeast Asian countries via digital gateways. Many a time, the money was even traced to countries like Taiwan





THE MISSING LINKS

Law enforcement has arrested mule account-holders and local agents during attempts to withdraw their small share of the funds. Some hiring agents based abroad have also been apprehended. However, the decentralised nature of the scam makes it nearly impossible to establish the money trail across borders